

Weak Two-bids

Open 2♦, 2♥ or 2♠ with a 6-card suit headed by some honors and fewer 4-9 HCP.

Response of a new suit is not forcing. (Note: some pairs play this 1-round force)

Raise of Opener's suit is to play.

Response of 2NT is forcing and asks for further information.

After 2NT Response, Opener bids:

- 3 of original suit to show a weak hand

- 3 of another suit to show a good hand with high card in that suit

- 3NT with a suit of A K Q x x x

Preemptive Bids

An opening bid of 3 of any suit shows a 7-card suit and less than opening hand.

This is primarily a defensive bid, and you should be mindful of vulnerability, being more cautious when you are Vulnerable against Non-Vulnerable opponents. For these Deals assume neither side is Vulnerable.

As a rule of thumb, Responder should assume Opener can win six tricks and bid accordingly.

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠9

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠Q

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Lead: ♦K

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♦4

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 3 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ K 10 8 6 2

♣ 7 2

♠ A Q J 10 6 5

♥ 7

♦ A 9 5

♣ K J 3



♠ 9

♥ J 9 3

♦ Q J 7 3

♣ A Q 10 8 4

♠ K 8 4

♥ A Q 10 6 4 2

♦ 4

♣ 9 6 5

NORTH expects to be better off in ♠s than SOUTH would be in 2♥.

Whether or not you play a new suit as a one round force or not, SOUTH should make the 3♠ bid with a hand this good. NORTH then bids the ♠ game.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♠

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

Lead: ♠9

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 7 5

♥ K 6 3

♦ K Q J 5 4

♣ A

♠ 9 4 2

♥ 2

♦ 10 9 7

♣ Q 9 6 5 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6

♥ A Q J 8 7 5 4

♦ 6 3 2

♣ 8 4

♠ Q J 10 8 3

♥ 10 9

♦ A 8

♣ K J 10 7

EAST has a pretty normal 3♥ opening bid.

WEST, however, has a big hand, and she launches into Blackwood.

When EAST shows one Ace WEST can bid 6♥ with confidence.

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♦

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by East

Lead: ♠Q

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 7 6 5
♥ 9 3 2
♦ A K 6 5
♣ 6 3

♠ J 3

♥ 7 6

♦ 9 7

♣ K Q 9 8 7 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 8 4 2

♥ A 10 8 5 4

♦ 8 4 2

♣ 4

♠ A Q 10

♥ K Q J

♦ Q J 10 3

♣ A J 10

*West**North**East**South*

3♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♦ K

NORTH doesn't have much of a 3♣ opening bid.

But SOUTH has just the type of hand you need to bid 3NT after partner's preempt. The other three suits well stopped, and certain entry in Opener's long suit. Notice here that 3NT is a good contract, but 5♣ would go down 1.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 4
♥ K J 10 9 6 3
♦ 8 7 5
♣ 4 2

♠ 10 7 5

♥ 7 5

♦ J 6 4 3

♣ A 8 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 6 3
♥ Q 8 2
♦ A K Q
♣ K Q J

♠ K 9 8 2

♥ A 4

♦ 10 9 2

♣ 10 9 7 5

West

2♥

3♥

All Pass

4♥ by West

Lead: ♦ 4

North

Pass

Pass

East

2NT

4♥

South

Pass

When WEST opens with a Weak 2♥ bid, EAST knows she will force to game but is thinking about slam.

But first she needs to know if WEST has anything extra. She bids 2NT to get more information.

WEST returns to ♥s to show bare minimum so EAST settles for game.